

1-ON-1 COACHING · BUILT FROM OUR CONSULT CALL

LEX: HYBRID ATHLETE PERFORMANCE PROGRAM

CLIENT

Lex (IG: @Whois.l3x)

COACH

Echelon Fitness Collective

GOAL

Hybrid Athletic Development — Muscle
Gain + Performance

TIMELINE

Start date TBD → approx. March 2027
(28 weeks)

STRUCTURE

4 strength/speed days + Zone 2 + long
run + 1 recovery day

LEVEL

Advanced

A 28-week hybrid build: strength that transfers, muscle that shows, and the conditioning to run it all down, built around the split you already designed, with knee-friendly mechanics woven through every heavy day.

WHY I BUILT IT THIS WAY

On the split

You already built this one. The hybrid routine you sent over is almost exactly what we're running, I mostly formalized the periodization and merged it with a phase structure. When something works and it's clearly yours, my job is to sharpen it, not replace it.

On "not a bodybuilder, not a powerlifter"

Compound lifts stay first when you're freshest (Monday and Friday), accessory volume stays moderate instead of chasing size in one direction, and speed work, Zone 2, and a long run are layered in so the engine keeps pace with the strength. That's the "weak in

the middle" problem solved, strength, size, and conditioning develop together instead of one eating into the others.

On the knee

A click with no pain usually points to a tracking or stability issue, not a structural one, but I'm not a physician, so get it looked at once before we push the plyometric work harder (see the note below). In the meantime, box squats replace free squats on Monday, controlling depth and shear force, Controlled Articular Rotations go into every warm-up, and single-leg and posterior-chain work builds the stability that usually resolves a painless click over time.

On the "5% body fat" target

I want to be straight with you on this one. 5% is stage-shredded, competition-only condition, essentially unsustainable, and it actively fights muscle gain since your body needs some fat reserve to build and recover. What actually gets you strong, muscular, and lean in a way you can hold onto sits closer to 8–12%: visible abs, visible separation, still enough in the tank to keep adding muscle and mileage. That's the number this program is actually built toward. If you want to chase single digits for a specific event down the line, we can run a short, planned cut for that, but not as the year-round target.

On the calendar

Your own program already builds in a deload every 4th week. I kept that exactly as you designed it and used it as the engine for the whole periodization below, instead of imposing a different rhythm on top of it.

Programmed to the ISSA CPT standard, for Echelon Fitness Collective.

28-WEEK ROADMAP

PHASE	WEEKS	FOCUS
Phase 1: Foundation & Knee Stability	1–8	Box squat depth and bar path get full attention before load climbs. Controlled Articular Rotations become a daily habit. Moderate loads everywhere while movement quality locks in. Deloads at Week 4 and Week 8.

Phase 2: Strength & Engine Build	9–16	Main lifts progress toward heavier strength blocks (4×4–6). Tempo runs get faster, Zone 2 volume increases. Deloads at Week 12 and Week 16.
Phase 3: Hybrid Peak	17–24	Heaviest strength numbers of the block. Hypertrophy accessories run at higher volume. Threshold, 400m, and tempo paces all get faster. Nutrition shifts toward the cut. Deloads at Week 20 and Week 24.
Phase 4: Polish & Performance Test	25–28	Volume tapers ~15%. Week 28: retest the main lifts, the speed protocols, and the long run distance against Week 1 baseline, to see the actual gap closed.

WEEKLY STRUCTURE

DAY	FOCUS	WHY IT'S PLACED HERE
Day 1	Full Body Strength A (Lower Emphasis)	Fresh CNS for the week's heaviest lower-body pull; box squat mechanics get full attention before fatigue sets in.
Day 2	Zone 2 Conditioning	Recovery-paced aerobic work the day after the heaviest lower session; builds the engine without adding load.
Day 3	Upper Body Performance & Hypertrophy	Full lower-body recovery; heaviest upper pressing and pulling of the week.
Day 4	Speed / Tempo Development (rotating)	Legs recovered from Monday, fresh for top-end speed work.
Day 5	Full Body Strength B (Posterior Chain)	Second full-body strength stimulus, posterior-chain-biased to balance Day 1's quad-dominant box squat.
Day 6	Recovery & Knee-Mobility Flow	Active recovery before the long run; where the CARs and hip/knee mobility work get dedicated time.
Day 7	Long Run (Aerobic Base)	Builds the "run also" piece from our call, conversational pace, capped so it doesn't eat into Day 1.

On Load: you didn't send over current working weights, so every lift below starts at "establish Week 1" instead of a guessed number. Log the actual weight you use for each lift in the Hub the first time you run it, that becomes your baseline, and every week after that you're progressing against your own number, not mine.

HEAVY · ~60 MIN

DAY 1 / MONDAY — FULL BODY STRENGTH A (LOWER EMPHASIS)

WARM-UP

- Bike — 5 min easy spin
- Band Activation (monster walk, lateral band walk) — 2 × 15 steps/side
- Knee CARs (Controlled Articular Rotations) — 2 × 5 slow circles/side
- Box Jumps or Broad Jumps — 3 × 3

STRENGTH

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	LOAD	NOTES
Barbell Box Squat	3 × 5–6	Establish Week 1, log in Hub	Box height sets your depth, sit back onto it, don't drop. Controls shear force on the knee.
Romanian Deadlift	3 × 6–8	Establish Week 1, log in Hub	Hips travel back not down, soft knee bend, feel the hamstring stretch before reversing.

UPPER STRENGTH

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	LOAD
Incline Dumbbell Press	3 × 6–8	Establish Week 1, log in Hub
Lat Pulldown (wide grip)	3 × 8	Establish Week 1, log in Hub

ACCESSORIES

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	LOAD
Cable Lateral Raise	2 × 12–15	Light, log in Hub
Rope Tricep Pushdown	2 × 12–15	Light, log in Hub
Cable Crunch	3 × 12	Bodyweight/cable stack, log in Hub

EASY · 45–60 MIN

DAY 2 / TUESDAY — ZONE 2 CONDITIONING

- **Zone 2 Cardio (Run or Bike)** — 45–60 min. Heart rate stays conversational the entire time; if you can't hold a conversation, you're going too hard.
- Optional mobility flow afterward — 10 min, hips and ankles.

MODERATE–HEAVY · ~60 MIN

DAY 3 / WEDNESDAY — UPPER BODY PERFORMANCE & HYPERTROPHY

MAIN STRENGTH

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	LOAD
Flat Barbell Bench Press	3 × 5–6	Establish Week 1, log in Hub
Chest-Supported Row	3 × 6–8	Establish Week 1, log in Hub

SECONDARY

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	LOAD	NOTES
Weighted Pull-Up	3 × 6–8	Bodyweight until clean, then add load, log in Hub	Add weight only once you can hit 3×8 bodyweight clean.

Standing Barbell Overhead Press	3 × 6–8	Establish Week 1, log in Hub	
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HYPERTROPHY

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	LOAD
Cable Fly (high-to-low angle)	2 × 12	Light, log in Hub
Face Pull	2 × 15	Light, log in Hub
Dumbbell Biceps Curl (alternating)	2 × 10	Light, log in Hub
Overhead Rope Tricep Extension	2 × 10	Light, log in Hub

MODERATE · 30–40 MIN OF RUNNING WORK — ROTATE A → B → C WEEKLY, THEN REPEAT

DAY 4 / THURSDAY — SPEED / TEMPO DEVELOPMENT

Week A: Threshold Intervals — 5 × 4 min at threshold pace, 2 min easy jog between.

Week B: 400m Repeats — 6–8 × 400m at goal 5K pace or faster, full recovery between.

Week C: Tempo Run — 20–25 min continuous at a "comfortably hard" pace, faster than Zone 2, controlled the whole way.

The same three sessions get faster as the block progresses, that's the actual progression metric on this day.

HEAVY · ~60 MIN

DAY 5 / FRIDAY — FULL BODY STRENGTH B (POSTERIOR CHAIN)

WARM-UP

- Bike — 5 min
- Broad Jumps or Pogo Hops — 3 × 5

STRENGTH

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	LOAD	NOTES
Trap-Bar Deadlift	3 × 5	Establish Week 1, log in Hub	
Zercher Walking Lunge	3 × 8/leg	Establish Week 1, log in Hub	Front-loaded position builds the midline strength a straight bodybuilding split skips.

UPPER STRENGTH

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	LOAD
Standing Barbell Overhead Press	3 × 6	Establish Week 1, log in Hub
Seated Cable Row	3 × 8	Establish Week 1, log in Hub

HYPERTROPHY FINISH

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	LOAD
Seated Leg Curl	2 × 10	Light, log in Hub
Machine Chest Fly	2 × 12	Light, log in Hub
Hammer Curl	2 × 10	Light, log in Hub
Skull Crusher	2 × 10	Light, log in Hub
Hanging Knee Raises	3 × 10	Bodyweight, log in Hub

DAY 6 / SATURDAY — RECOVERY & KNEE-MOBILITY FLOW

EXERCISE	VOLUME	NOTES
Knee CARs (Controlled Articular Rotations)	2 × 5 slow circles/side	
Cossack Squats	10/side, dynamic	
Supported Wall Sit	3 × 30–45 sec	Builds quad/VMO endurance without joint shear, directly targets what usually quiets a painless knee click.
Foam Rolling (Quads, IT Band, Calves)	2 min/area	
Butterfly Stretch	1 min	
Frog Stretch	1–2 min	

Optional: sauna or cold plunge, easy walk.

EASY · 60–90 MIN

DAY 7 / SUNDAY — LONG RUN (AEROBIC BASE)

Long Run (Conversational Pace) — 60–90 min. Same rule as Zone 2: if you can't talk, slow down. This is the "run also" piece from our call, capped so it doesn't compromise Day 1.

NUTRITION PROTOCOL

Your goal is both "build muscle" and "get lean," and those pull in opposite directions at the extremes you named. Here's the honest split: we build first, then we cut, not both at once, that's how it actually works at an advanced level.

MACRO	TARGET
Protein	1.0 g per lb of bodyweight/day
Fat	0.35 g per lb of bodyweight/day
Carbs	Fills the rest of the target: higher in the Build phases, lower in the Cut phase
Calories	Maintenance + ~250–300 kcal in Build phases, Maintenance – ~350–400 kcal in the Cut phase

- **Phases 1 & 2 (Weeks 1–16, Build):** modest surplus, carbs concentrated around lifting days (Mon/Wed/Fri). This is where the muscle gets built.
- **Phase 3 (Weeks 17–24, Cut):** controlled deficit. Protein and training volume stay put so the muscle built in Phases 1–2 doesn't get eaten into, this is where the number on the scale and the mirror actually move toward that lean, defined look.
- **Phase 4 (Weeks 25–28, Maintain):** back to maintenance so you walk into the Week 28 retest recovered, not depleted.
- Exact gram targets lock in once we have your Week 1 morning weigh-in, log it in the Hub and I'll confirm the numbers the same day.
- Protein at every meal: chicken, fish, eggs, Greek yogurt, lean beef, cottage cheese.
- Sleep is already solid at 7 hours, that's a real advantage most clients don't have. Protect it.

General fitness and nutrition guidance from your coach, not a substitute for individualized clinical dietary advice. Get the knee looked at by a physician before we push the plyometric or box jump work to higher intensity, given the click you mentioned on the call.

MOBILITY & KNEE HEALTH: FREQUENCY, NOT JUST A DAY

A click with no pain is common and usually mechanical, not damage, but frequency of the right kind of work is what actually changes it, not one Saturday session.

- Knee CARs go in every single warm-up, all seven days, not just Saturday, that's the real fix.
- Box squat depth stays fixed at parallel or just above until the click is a non-issue for 4 straight weeks, then we can explore deeper ranges.

- Track how the knee feels weekly (fine / mild click / anything sharper) in the Hub; sharp or painful is the stop signal, mild painless clicking is not.

ACCOUNTABILITY: WHAT WE TRACK

WEEKLY IN THE HUB

WHAT	FREQUENCY	WHY
Sessions completed	Weekly	Target 6/6 (Days 1–5 + the Sunday long run), 5/6.
Body weight	1×/week, same morning conditions	Sets your nutrition targets and confirms the Build/Cut phases are actually working.
Protein grams	Daily, even if estimated	The one macro that protects the muscle thr the Cut phase.
Main lift numbers (Box Squat, Bench, Trap-Bar Deadlift, Standing OHP)	Weekly	The real strength progress marker for a hybrid athlete, more useful than a mirror check sor weeks.
Speed day time/pace	Weekly (Thursdays)	Threshold pace, 400m splits, and tempo pac trend down as the engine improves, that's t conditioning half of "hybrid" showing up in t numbers.
Knee status	Weekly	Fine / mild click / other. The early-warning sy for the mobility work.

Your own routine did most of the work here, I mostly gave it a runway, a periodization system, and a plan for the knee. Check in through the Member Portal on how Week 1 feels, and log your morning weight so I can lock your nutrition targets the same day.

ECHELON FITNESS COLLECTIVE: STRUCTURE. ACCOUNTABILITY. COMMITMENT. FAITH.